

CV Sections & Best Practices

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1. Contact Information

This is the first and most basic section of your CV. It allows employers to reach you easily.

Include:

- Full Name (as it appears professionally)
 - Phone Number (active and reachable)
 - Professional Email Address (avoid using informal or outdated emails)
 - LinkedIn Profile or Personal Website (if relevant)
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2. Career Objective

A short statement that summarizes your career goals and what you bring to the job. It should be tailored to the specific role for which you are applying.

Example:

A highly motivated marketing graduate seeking an entry-level position where I can apply my creative skills and contribute to building brand awareness.

3. Education

List your academic qualifications in reverse chronological order (most recent first).

Include:

- Degree/Certificate earned
 - Institution name
 - Graduation date (or expected date)
 - GPA (optional, if strong)
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4. Experience (Work / Internships)

This section highlights your practical experience in the workforce or during internships. It helps employers understand what tasks you've handled and what value you can bring to their company.

For each entry, include:

- Job/Internship Title
 - Company/Organization Name
 - Location (City, Country – optional)
 - Dates (Start – End)
 - Key Responsibilities and Achievements (written as bullet points)
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5. Courses

Mention professional or short courses you've taken outside your formal education.

Include:

- Course Title
 - Provider/Platform (e.g., Coursera, Udemy, Edraak)
 - Completion Date
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6. Skills

This section showcases your capabilities and strengths relevant to the job you are applying for. It helps employers quickly assess whether you have the technical and interpersonal skills needed for the role.

7. Projects

Showcase practical experiences that demonstrate your skills in real-world scenarios.

Include:

- Project Title
 - Your Role (Team Leader, Developer, Designer, etc.)
 - Tools / Technologies Used
 - Brief description or result
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8. Extracurricular Activities

Activities outside the classroom reflect your personality, interests, and soft skills.

Examples:

- Volunteering
- Sports Teams

- University Clubs
 - Student Organizations
 - Event Organization
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CV Layout & Final Tips

Formatting

- Keep your CV to **one page** whenever possible; **one and a half pages** is acceptable, and **two pages** should be the maximum.
 - Use professional fonts such as **Times New Roman** in **10–12 pt** size.
 - Use **no more than two professional font families** throughout the CV.
 - Maintain consistent formatting for headings, spacing, capitalization, and bullet points.
 - Use bullet points instead of long paragraphs.
 - Keep margins clean and spacing balanced.
 - Export and send your CV as a **PDF**.
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Content

- Do **not** include a photo unless it is specifically requested.
 - Do **not** use icons.
 - Do **not** use colors.
 - Do **not** use italics or underlining; use **bold** only to emphasize important information.
 - Avoid writing words in **ALL CAPS**.
 - Pay close attention to the accuracy of all information.
 - Avoid repeating information. For example, do not mention your target job title again in the Contact Information section.
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Personal Information

- Do **not** include unnecessary personal details such as:
 - Date of Birth
 - Nationality
 - Avoid listing your full address if you are applying for jobs outside your current location. Discuss relocation later during the interview if needed.
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Career Objective vs. Professional Summary

Choose the appropriate section based on your experience:

Use **Career Objective** if:

- You have **less than two years** of professional experience.

Use **Professional Summary** if:

- You have **more than two years** of professional experience.

A good objective or summary should follow this structure:

1. Who you are.
2. What skills or expertise you have.
3. Why you are applying for this role.

Experience

- List experiences in **reverse chronological order**.
- If you are currently an **intern**, it is perfectly acceptable to mention that you are still a student.
- Do not mention freelance work or another employer if you are applying for a full-time position elsewhere.
- Use **years only** instead of months unless the timeline is particularly important.

Education

- Include formal education such as:
 - Bachelor's Degree
 - Diploma
 - Master's Degree
 - PhD
- GPA is optional and is generally worth including only if it is particularly strong.

Projects & Courses

- Include **3–5** strong projects.
- Include **3–5** relevant professional courses.
- Focus on quality rather than quantity.

Skills

- For technical roles, listing soft skills is optional. Prioritize technical skills that are relevant to the position.
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ATS Optimization

Before submitting your CV, compare it against the job description using an **ATS (Applicant Tracking System) resume checker** to evaluate keyword matching and overall compatibility.